

Global Travel Policy

Narsimha Tech | Effective: 1 January 2025 | Internal Use Only

1. Introduction & Principles

1.1 Purpose

This Global Travel Policy governs all business travel undertaken by Narsimha Tech employees and contractors acting on behalf of the company, whether within India or internationally. The policy balances employee wellbeing, duty of care, and cost efficiency, and applies regardless of the funding source for the trip (Company budget, client-billed, or partner-funded).

1.2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees, consultants, and contractors travelling on Company business, including travel for client meetings, conferences, training, internal offsites, and project deployments. Personal travel is not covered, except where a business trip is extended for personal reasons, in which case Section 9 (Personal Extensions) applies.

1.3 Roles and Responsibilities

- **Travelling Employee:** Responsible for obtaining approval before booking, complying with booking guidelines, and submitting timely, accurate expense reports.
- **Line Manager:** Responsible for assessing the business need and approving travel within their delegated authority.
- **Department Head:** Responsible for approving travel above the line manager's delegated threshold and ensuring departmental travel budgets are respected.
- **Travel Desk (within Finance):** Responsible for administering the Travel Portal, liaising with the TMC, and supporting employees with booking issues.
- **HR and CISO:** Jointly responsible for duty-of-care matters, particularly for travel to higher-risk destinations.

2. Travel Authorisation

2.1 Approval Thresholds

All business travel requires advance written approval. Domestic travel with a total projected cost below INR 15,000 requires only line manager approval. Domestic travel exceeding INR 15,000 and all international travel require approval from both the line manager and the department head.

2.2 Lead Time for Requests

Travel requests must be submitted via the Narsimha Tech Travel Portal at <https://travel.narsimhatech.com> a minimum of 5 business days before departure for domestic trips and 14 business days for international trips. Submitting later than this may still be processed but is subject to additional scrutiny and the risk of higher fares due to late booking.

2.3 Emergency Travel

Emergency travel may proceed without prior approval but must be retroactively authorised within 24 hours. The employee or their manager must submit the Travel Authorisation retrospectively in the portal, clearly marked as an emergency, with a brief justification.

2.4 Unauthorised Travel

Unauthorised travel will not be reimbursed. "Unauthorised" includes travel undertaken without any approval at all, travel that materially exceeds the scope (destination, duration, class of travel) of what was approved, and travel booked outside the approved channels described in Section 3 without a valid exception.

2.5 Project-Based Standing Approvals

For roles requiring frequent, recurring travel to a specific client site (for example, a weekly on-site rotation), the department head may approve a Standing Travel Authorisation covering a defined period (up to 3 months), reducing the need for individual trip-by-trip approval while still requiring each specific booking to be logged in the Travel Portal.

2.6 Approval Matrix

Trip Type	Cost Threshold	Approver(s)	Lead Time
Domestic	Below INR 15,000	Line Manager	5 business days
Domestic	INR 15,000 and above	Line Manager + Department Head	5 business days

Trip Type	Cost Threshold	Approver(s)	Lead Time
International	Any amount	Line Manager + Department Head	14 business days
Emergency (domestic or international)	Any amount	Retroactive, within 24 hours	N/A

3. Booking Guidelines

3.1 Authorised Booking Channels

All flights, trains, and hotels must be booked through the company's authorised travel management company (TMC): MakeMyTrip Corporate (domestic) and FCM Travel (international), or via the integrated portal. Self-booked travel through consumer sites is generally not reimbursed unless the TMC system was unavailable, and the employee obtained prior written confirmation from the Travel Desk that a self-booking exception applied.

3.2 Class of Travel

Economy/Coach class is mandatory for all domestic travel and for international flights of 6 hours or less. Business class may be approved for international flights exceeding 6 hours for employees at Director level and above, or for any employee with a documented medical condition requiring additional space, supported by appropriate medical documentation submitted to HR in advance.

3.3 Advance Booking

Bookings should be made at least 14 days in advance to secure the best available fares. Where business necessity requires booking closer to departure, the higher resulting fare is accepted as a reasonable business cost, but repeated late bookings by the same individual or team without genuine justification may be flagged by Finance for review.

3.4 Personal Loyalty Programmes

Employees may use personal loyalty miles for upgrades at zero additional cost to the company. The Company does not reimburse the cost of acquiring miles or points, and employees may retain personal loyalty points earned on Company-funded travel for their own use, consistent with standard market practice, provided this does not increase the cost to the Company (for example, by selecting a more expensive fare class purely to earn more points).

3.5 Group and Conference Travel

For group travel (3 or more employees travelling together to the same event), the relevant department head should coordinate a single consolidated booking through the Travel Desk where feasible, to optimise group fares and accommodation rates.

3.6 Visa and Documentation

Employees travelling internationally are responsible for ensuring their passport has at least 6 months' validity remaining and for initiating any visa application well in advance of the 14-day booking lead time, as visa processing for some destinations can take several weeks. The Travel Desk can provide guidance on

visa requirements but the employee remains responsible for ensuring timely, accurate submission.

3.7 Travel for Dependents

Travel costs for an employee's spouse, family, or other dependents accompanying them on a business trip are not reimbursed by the Company, except where specifically approved as part of a relocation or long-term assignment arrangement under a separate Global Mobility agreement.

4. Domestic Travel — Per Diem & Accommodation

4.1 Per Diem Rates

For business travel within India, the following daily per diem rates apply for meals and incidentals: Metro Cities (Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata, Pune) — INR 2,500 per day; Tier-2 Cities — INR 1,800 per day; Tier-3 Cities and towns — INR 1,200 per day.

4.2 Hotel Accommodation Caps

Hotel accommodation is reimbursed on actuals subject to nightly caps: Metro Cities — INR 6,000; Tier-2 Cities — INR 4,000; Tier-3 Cities — INR 2,500. Employees must use Narsimha Tech's partner hotels (listed on the travel portal) where available, as these rates are typically pre-negotiated below the nightly cap.

4.3 Exceeding the Accommodation Cap

Accommodation above the cap requires pre-approval and is reimbursed only when no partner hotel options exist — for example, due to a major local event causing partner hotels to be fully booked. Such exceptions must be documented in the expense report with a brief explanation and, where possible, evidence of partner hotel unavailability.

4.4 Partial-Day Per Diem

Per diems are reduced by 50% on the day of departure and return if travel spans less than 6 hours of the working day. For example, an employee departing at 4:00 PM for an overnight trip receives 50% per diem for the departure day and full per diem for any full subsequent day.

4.5 City Tier Classification Table

Tier	Example Cities	Per Diem (INR/day)	Hotel Cap (INR/night)
Metro	Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata, Pune	2,500	6,000
Tier-2	Jaipur, Lucknow, Coimbatore, Indore, Nagpur, Vadodara	1,800	4,000
Tier-3	Smaller towns and districts not listed above	1,200	2,500

4.6 Multi-City Domestic Itineraries

For trips covering multiple cities in different tiers, the per diem and hotel cap applicable to each city is applied for the nights/days spent in that city, calculated proportionally based on the itinerary recorded in the Travel Portal.

4.7 Day Trips (No Overnight Stay)

For domestic day trips not requiring an overnight stay, only a reduced meal allowance (50% of the applicable city per diem) is payable, as no accommodation cost is incurred; ground transportation is reimbursed per Section 6.

5. International Travel — Per Diem & Accommodation

5.1 Per Diem Rates by Region

International per diem rates (meals and incidentals, per calendar day) are: USA & Canada — USD 85; United Kingdom — GBP 75; Western Europe — EUR 75; Singapore & Australia — USD 90; Middle East (UAE, Saudi, Qatar) — USD 65; Southeast Asia (Thailand, Malaysia, Philippines, Vietnam) — USD 55; Japan & South Korea — USD 80; All other destinations — USD 60.

5.2 Hotel Accommodation Caps

Hotel accommodation is reimbursed on actuals up to USD 200 per night in standard destinations and up to USD 320 per night in premium cities (New York, London, Zurich, Singapore, Tokyo, San Francisco).

5.3 Travel Advances

Employees must request a Travel Advance for trips expected to exceed 5 days; advances must be requested at least 7 business days before departure and reconciled within 10 business days of return. Unreconciled advances outstanding beyond 30 days of return may be recovered directly from the employee's next payroll cycle.

5.4 Currency and Exchange Rate Handling

Expenses incurred in a foreign currency are reimbursed in INR (for India-based employees) at the exchange rate published by SAP Concur on the date of the transaction, or, where unavailable, the rate published by the Company's banking partner on the date closest to the transaction.

5.5 International Per Diem Summary Table

Region	Per Diem (per day)	Standard Hotel Cap	Premium City Hotel Cap
USA & Canada	USD 85	USD 200	USD 320 (New York, San Francisco)
United Kingdom	GBP 75	USD 200 equivalent	USD 320 (London)
Western Europe	EUR 75	USD 200 equivalent	USD 320 (Zurich)
Singapore & Australia	USD 90	USD 200	USD 320 (Singapore)
Middle East	USD 65	USD 200	N/A
Southeast Asia	USD 55	USD 200	N/A

Region	Per Diem (per day)	Standard Hotel Cap	Premium City Hotel Cap
Japan & South Korea	USD 80	USD 200	USD 320 (Tokyo)
All other destinations	USD 60	USD 200	N/A

5.6 Long-Term International Assignments

Employees on a long-term international assignment (continuous stay exceeding 30 days at a single location) transition from the daily per diem model described above to a Long-Term Assignment Allowance, governed by a separate Global Mobility Policy and individual assignment letter, which typically provides a monthly cost-of-living allowance in place of daily per diems.

5.7 Client-Site Meals

Where meals are provided by the client at no cost during a business visit (for example, at an on-site cafeteria or a hosted client dinner), the employee should reduce their per diem claim proportionally for the meals actually provided, consistent with the "no double-dipping" principle applied across this policy.

6. Ground Transportation

6.1 Preferred Options

Airport and station transfers should use the most economical practical option: metro rail, pre-paid taxi counters, or Ola/Uber Corporate (where the company account is active).

6.2 Receipts

Receipts are required for all individual ground transport expenses above INR 200 / USD 5.

6.3 Rental Cars

Rental cars require specific pre-approval from the department head and must be booked with comprehensive insurance; personal vehicles may not be substituted without approval.

6.4 Personal Vehicle Reimbursement

Personal vehicle use is reimbursed at INR 8 per km for two-wheelers and INR 15 per km for four-wheelers, capped at 100 km per day. Mileage claims must be supported by a brief log of origin, destination, and business purpose for each trip.

6.5 Chauffeur-Driven and Luxury Vehicles

Chauffeur-driven taxis and luxury vehicles are not reimbursable without VP-level approval, reflecting the Company's general preference for cost-efficient ground transportation options.

6.6 Parking and Tolls

Parking fees and road tolls incurred during approved business travel are reimbursable on submission of receipts where available, or a reasonable estimate with explanation where receipts are not issued (for example, certain toll booths).

7. Expense Reporting & Reimbursement

7.1 Submission System and Timeline

All travel expenses must be submitted via SAP Concur (the company expense management system) within 10 business days of returning from a trip.

7.2 Late Submission Tiers

Late submissions (11-30 days) will be reviewed and reimbursed at management discretion; submissions after 30 days will not be reimbursed without VP approval.

7.3 Required Documentation

Expense reports must include: the approved Travel Authorisation Number, original receipts (physical or digital) for all items above INR 500 / USD 10, a brief business purpose statement, and the names of any clients entertained (for business meals).

7.4 Expenses Without Receipts

Expenses without receipts are capped at INR 500 / USD 10 per item, and the employee must provide a written explanation for the missing receipt within the expense report itself.

7.5 Fraudulent or Inflated Claims

Fraudulent, inflated, or duplicate expense claims constitute gross misconduct and may result in immediate termination, consistent with the gross misconduct provisions in the Terms of Employment, Section 11.2.

7.6 Expense Categories and Typical Treatment

Category	Receipt Threshold	Typical Approval Level
Airfare / Rail (via TMC)	Always required	Pre-approved via Travel Authorisation
Hotel	Always required	Within cap: automatic; above cap: pre-approval per Section 4.3
Meals (per diem)	Not required (per diem is a fixed allowance)	Automatic within policy

Category	Receipt Threshold	Typical Approval Level
Client entertainment	Always required	Manager approval + client names recorded
Ground transport	Above INR 200 / USD 5	Automatic within policy
Miscellaneous (laundry, etc.)	Above INR 500 / USD 10	Manager review

7.7 Audit and Sampling

Finance periodically audits a sample of submitted expense reports for policy compliance. Employees should retain original receipts (physical or scanned) for at least 90 days after submission in case of an audit query.

8. Travel Insurance

8.1 Coverage for International Travel

Narsimha Tech provides comprehensive group travel insurance for all pre-authorised international business travel. Coverage includes emergency medical treatment and evacuation (up to USD 500,000), trip cancellation and interruption, checked baggage loss (up to USD 2,000), and 24/7 emergency assistance.

8.2 Activation

The policy is activated automatically for approved trips; employees must carry the digital insurance card available on the travel portal at all times during the trip.

8.3 Emergency Assistance Line

The 24/7 emergency assistance line is: +91-80-4567-8900.

8.4 Domestic Travel Coverage

For domestic travel, employees are covered under the company's group personal accident insurance, details of which are available from HR on request.

8.5 Personal Extensions and Insurance

Personal extensions of business trips for tourism are the employee's own responsibility for insurance purposes; the Company's group travel insurance does not extend to the personal-travel portion of a combined trip (see Section 9).

8.6 Claims Process

In the event of a need to claim under the travel insurance policy, the employee should contact the 24/7 emergency assistance line immediately for urgent matters, and separately notify HR and the Travel Desk within 5 business days to initiate any necessary claims paperwork.

9. Personal Extensions of Business Trips

9.1 Principle

Employees may extend a business trip for personal travel (a "bleisure" trip), subject to manager approval and the principles in this section.

9.2 Cost Allocation

The Company bears the cost of the business-purpose flight and accommodation up to the dates required for business activity; any additional flight cost arising from the extension (for example, a higher fare due to different return dates) and all accommodation, meals, and incidental costs for the personal portion are borne entirely by the employee.

9.3 Insurance During the Personal Portion

As noted in Section 8.5, Company travel insurance does not cover the personal-travel portion; employees are strongly encouraged to arrange their own travel insurance for this period.

9.4 Approval and Documentation

The employee should clearly mark the business and personal segments of the itinerary in the Travel Authorisation request, so that Finance can correctly apportion costs at the expense reporting stage.

10. Duty of Care & Travel Safety

10.1 High-Risk Destination Approval

Before travelling to any destination with a Government of India or host-country travel advisory at Level 3 (Reconsider Travel) or above, explicit written approval from the VP of Operations and the CISO is required.

10.2 Itinerary Registration

Employees must register their full itinerary (flights, hotels, in-country contacts) in the Travel Portal before departure, enabling the company to locate and assist them in any crisis.

10.3 Emergency Hotline

In the event of a natural disaster, civil unrest, serious medical emergency, or security incident, employees must call the 24/7 Duty of Care Hotline at +91-80-4567-8901 immediately.

10.4 Recall and Repatriation

Narsimha Tech reserves the right to recall employees from any location that becomes unsafe, with all associated repatriation costs borne by the company.

10.5 Pre-Travel Safety Briefing

Employees travelling to a destination with an elevated risk rating (Level 2 or above) should complete a pre-travel safety briefing arranged through HR, covering local emergency contacts, areas to avoid, and any destination-specific health precautions (such as required vaccinations).

10.6 Female and Solo Traveller Safety Considerations

The Company provides additional duty-of-care support for solo travellers and, where requested, can arrange for ground transportation to be booked door-to-door (rather than relying on public transport) for late-night arrivals or departures, at no additional approval burden beyond the standard ground transportation provisions in Section 6.

10.7 Health Precautions

Employees travelling to destinations requiring specific vaccinations or health precautions should consult the Company's occupational health provider, details of which are available from HR, sufficiently in advance of departure to complete any required course of vaccination.

11. Sustainability & Responsible Travel

11.1 Principle

Narsimha Tech encourages employees to consider the environmental impact of business travel and to favour virtual meetings where they can achieve the same business outcome as in-person travel.

11.2 Rail vs. Air for Domestic Travel

For domestic routes where rail travel (particularly high-speed or premium rail services) offers a reasonably comparable total journey time to air travel, employees are encouraged to consider rail as the lower-emission option, though this remains a recommendation rather than a mandate.

11.3 Carbon Reporting

The Company tracks aggregate travel-related carbon emissions as part of its sustainability reporting; individual trip data captured in the Travel Portal feeds into this reporting and is not used to evaluate individual employee travel choices.

12. Roles, Governance & Document Control

12.1 Policy Exceptions

Any exception to this policy not explicitly provided for above requires written approval from the relevant Department Head and the Head of Finance, documented in the Travel Portal against the specific trip.

12.2 Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually by Finance and HR, and updated as needed to reflect changes in per diem benchmarks, partner hotel agreements, and regulatory requirements.

12.3 Related Policies

This policy should be read alongside the Terms of Employment (particularly regarding gross misconduct and expense fraud), the Employee Handbook (Code of Conduct on gifts and hospitality, relevant to client entertainment), and the IT & Information Security Policy (regarding use of Company devices and VPN while travelling).

12.4 Document Control

Attribute	Detail
Document Owner	Head of Finance, in partnership with Head of HR
Review Frequency	Annual
Last Reviewed	January 2025
Related Documents	Terms of Employment; Employee Handbook; Detailed Leave Policy

13. Worked Examples

13.1 Example: Domestic Trip, Metro City

An employee travels from Hyderabad to Mumbai for a 3-day client workshop. Total estimated cost (flights + 2 nights' hotel) is INR 22,000, requiring Line Manager and Department Head approval since it exceeds INR 15,000. The employee books via MakeMyTrip Corporate, stays at a partner hotel within the INR 6,000/night cap, and claims INR 2,500/day per diem for 3 days (reduced by 50% on the travel day if under 6 hours), submitting the expense report via Concur within 10 business days of return.

13.2 Example: International Trip Requiring Business Class

A Director travels from Chennai to New York for a 9-hour flight to lead a client renewal negotiation. Given the flight exceeds 6 hours and the employee holds Director grade, Business Class is approved per Section 3.2. The employee requests a Travel Advance 7 business days before departure given the trip exceeds 5 days, stays within the USD 320/night premium-city cap, and claims the USD 85/day USA per diem, reconciling the advance within 10 business days of return.

13.3 Example: Emergency Domestic Travel

An engineer is asked to travel same-day to a client site in Pune to resolve a critical production issue. There is no time to submit a Travel Authorisation in advance. The employee travels, and the manager submits a retroactive Travel Authorisation within 24 hours, marked as an emergency, referencing the incident ticket number as justification.

13.4 Example: Bleisure Extension

An employee attending a 4-day conference in Singapore extends their stay by 3 additional personal days. The Company covers the conference-related flight and hotel costs for the business segment; the employee pays for the additional 3 nights' hotel and any change in flight fare resulting from the later return date, and arranges personal travel insurance for the extension period.

14. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I book my own flight if I find a cheaper fare than the TMC offers?

A: Generally no — Section 3.1 requires booking via the authorised TMC or integrated portal. If you believe a materially cheaper fare exists elsewhere, raise it with the Travel Desk, who can often match or explain the difference (for example, fare class restrictions).

Q: What if my flight is delayed and I incur an extra night's hotel cost?

A: This is reimbursable as a reasonable consequence of travel disruption; note the reason in your expense report and retain any airline delay documentation if available.

Q: I was hosted for dinner by the client and didn't pay — can I still claim a meal per diem for that day?

A: No; per Section 5.7, you should reduce your per diem claim for any meal provided by the client at no cost to you.

Q: Do per diems require itemised receipts for each meal?

A: No — per diems are a fixed daily allowance and do not require itemised meal receipts. Itemised receipts are required for client entertainment claimed separately from your own per diem (Section 7.3).

Q: My trip spans two regions with different per diem rates — how is this calculated?

A: Per diem is calculated based on the region/city you are physically in for each calendar day of the trip, consistent with the multi-city approach in Section 4.6 for domestic trips and the equivalent principle for international itineraries.

Q: Can I use a personal car instead of a rental car for a long client visit?

A: Personal vehicle use is reimbursed per Section 6.4 at the per-km rate, capped at 100 km/day; for longer distances, a rental car (with pre-approval) or train/flight is generally more appropriate and cost-effective.

Q: What happens if I lose a receipt for a major expense like a hotel bill?

A: Contact the hotel for a duplicate invoice where possible; if genuinely unavailable, the expense is still claimable but capped at the no-receipt threshold in Section 7.4 unless the Travel Desk can independently verify the cost (for example, via the TMC booking record).

Q: Is alcohol reimbursable as part of a business meal?

A: Reasonable alcohol consumption as part of client entertainment is generally reimbursable within the overall business meal cost, subject to your manager's judgement on what is reasonable for the context; excessive amounts may be queried during expense audit.

15. Appendix: Quick Reference Summary

15.1 Approval and Lead Time Quick Reference

Step	Domestic	International
Minimum lead time for request	5 business days	14 business days
Approval required	Line Manager (and Dept Head if over INR 15,000)	Line Manager + Department Head
Booking channel	MakeMyTrip Corporate / Travel Portal	FCM Travel / Travel Portal
Travel Advance threshold	N/A	Required for trips over 5 days
Expense submission deadline	10 business days post-trip	10 business days post-trip

15.2 Key Contacts

Purpose	Contact
Travel Portal / Booking support	Travel Desk, via the Travel Portal help section
24/7 Emergency Medical/Insurance Assistance	+91-80-4567-8900
24/7 Duty of Care Hotline (security/crisis)	+91-80-4567-8901
Expense queries	Finance Shared Services, via SAP Concur support ticket

15.3 Document Control

Attribute	Detail
Document Owner	Head of Finance, in partnership with Head of HR
Review Frequency	Annual
Last Reviewed	January 2025
Related Documents	Terms of Employment; Employee Handbook; Detailed Leave Policy